How many cars parked at UBC last year, and how much parking revenue did UBC generate?

Sameer Shankar

August 2026

Introduction

Publicly available data do not directly report the number of vehicles parked at UBC, therefore the analysis uses multiple independent data sources and key assumptions to answer the question.

Framework

Number of cars parked at UBC in 2025

According to the Transportation Status Report, there were $46,800$ trips to/from campus by single occupant vehicle at UBC Vancouver in 2025. Assuming inbound and outbound trips are approximately equal over the course of a day, the number of inbound trips is estimated as $\frac{46,800}{2} = 23,400$. Since every parked vehicle must first arrive on campus, inbound single-occupancy vehicle trips provide the closest public proxy for parking demand.

The report also states, "The 2022 survey results found that nearly 80% of people that drive also park on campus, while ...". If this is taken as the Pr(driver parks on campus), the number of estimated parked vehicles/day can be calculated.

Sensitivity Analysis

As the reported 80% figure is based on a 2022 survey and may have changed by 2025, a sensitivity analysis using parking proportions between 75% and 85% is performed.

Therefore, the point estimate of **parked** vehicles/day is

$$23,400 \times 0.80 = 18,720$$

This 18,720 vehicles/day figure represents parking during the Winter Sessions. These constitute ∼126 academic weekdays. Therefore the number of parked vehicles during the Winter Sessions is

$$18,720 \times 126 = 2,358,720$$

Using the same calculation, the range with 75% and 85% becomes,

$$(2,211,300, 2,506,140)$$

The Transportation Status Report specifies that data are collected in the fall, "Data on transportation has been recorded every Fall since 1997". Therefore, parking estimates for the remaining 239 days comprising the Summer Sessions, weekends, and holidays need to be calculated.

For the summer, the analysis assumes that parking demand is approximately 25% of the winter-session level. This reflects the end of the Winter Session, reduced student population, and substantially lower teaching activity during the summer months. Again, using the same calculation as above, the following is obtained.

$$23,400 \times 0.25 \times 0.8 \times 239 = 1,118,520$$

Combining the Winter and Summer Session results, the final point estimate and range is obtained;

- $3,477,240$
- $(3,259,912, 3,694,568)$

Amount of parking revenue generated by UBC in 2025

To find the amount of parking revenue generated by UBC in 2025, the following question needs to be asked: what does the average vehicle pay? According to the live UBC Parking website, the following information is available about the parkades:

- Most parkades have:
  - $22 weekday maximum
  - $11 evening maximum
  - $2.25 per half hour
- Some premium lots are $4.50/hr
- Permits with the following prices can be found:

  - 1 Year: $1,278.00
  - 1 Term: $431.64
  - 30 Days: $114.10
  - 1 Day: $11.23

Many people parking on campus daily are faculty, staff, and long-term students, some of whom purchase long-term passes (1 Term or 1 Year). When broken down per day, long-term permit holders pay a rate of $3.50 to $4.00. Furthermore, there are hourly drivers who stay for a quick meeting or class, paying around $4.50 total.

As the distribution of permit holders and short-term users is not publicly available, a baseline of $5 Revenue per Occupied Stall (RevPOS) is applied to account for the service mix profile. With this, the final point estimate and range for the total revenue is obtained,

- $17,386,200
- ($16,299,562, $18,472,838)

Validation

According to a 2012 University Community Services Report, "Parking Services' annual revenue is $10.2 million". Although this figure predates the current analysis by more than a decade, it provides an external benchmark against which the estimates can be compared.

Limitations

If the following factors are also accounted for, the estimates in this analysis would get closer to the figure mentioned by UBC,

- Off-Campus Parking: Many drivers park for free in the nearby University Endowment Lands or Westbrook Village
- Long Weekends: Campus parking demand on statutory holidays, especially ones when there are long weekends could fall below even the assumed 25% figure above